

Live Movie Maker, Apple iMovie, Lightworks, Blender, Pinnacle Spin and HyperEngine-AV. We encourage you to explore and experiment with these if you should feel like it since they all offer a piece of the puzzle without really solving the whole problem when video editing.

Avidemux

Get it at: <http://tinyurl.com/bn3lb4k>

Run it on: *Linux, Mac and Windows*

Avidemux was originally the Linux alternative for video editing solutions but was quickly ported to Windows and Mac due to functionality and price tag. The file offers a seamless installation and extreme conformity with the default layout of any other video editing tool. The centre of focus being the clip preview and adjusted video display panels under which is the timeline where editing takes place. The size and orientation of these panels can be adjusted as needed. However unlike traditional editing workflows Avidemux doesn't really allow users to switch around clips as desired, instead each clip needs to be imported to the timeline in a linear order of how you wish it to be placed. The clips are attached in the order imported without a Bin like panel where your clips would normally be stored and dropped into different parts of the timeline. This doesn't mean you can't reorganise your clips but it must be done using Cut and Paste options for each clip in the timeline to be moved elsewhere in the order. This restricts experimentation when trying out different playback options. With respect to features and tools Avidemux does offer an assortment of image improvement and adjustment tools like Brightness control, Contrast, Color, Resolution adjustment and Sharpening with instant preview. The application can export your final video in a variety of formats including device based presets for iPhones, iPods and PSP. It's a good blend of basic editing with essential features in a fairly simple interface that will work for most users.

VideoLAN Media Creator

Get it at: <http://videolan-movie-creator.en.softonic.com/>

Run it on: *Linux, Mac and Windows*

One of the most interesting open source video editors comes from the makers of the famous VLC Media Player. The VideoLAN Media Creator or VLMC is an ongoing development project by the VideoLAN Organisation that takes open sourced video production one step further than anyone else. The non linear non destructive video editing tool created by them is based on the